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REGIONAL OUTLOOK

The week’s most consequential exposure is the attack on the police headquarters in Kohat, where fatalities rose and fighting was still ongoing when reported. The immediate business risk is not a proven wider commercial shutdown, but an acute security shock around a state site that can interrupt staff movement, local site access and decision-making while conditions remain unsettled.

A separate operating issue is the cluster of weather and infrastructure disruptions in Japan, Sri Lanka and Thailand, which directly affect transport reliability rather than security conditions. Nepal's LPG shortage and the Philippine regulator's offline platform add slower-moving friction through fuel availability and administrative processing, but with less evidence so far of broad service stoppage.

WEEK AT A GLANCE

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REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

Direct disruption this week comes through two different channels. In Kohat, the confirmed attack and ongoing fighting create an immediate local security constraint for employers with people, deliveries or public-facing activity near the affected area. That is a direct access and duty-of-care problem, not confirmed evidence of wider transport closure.

Elsewhere, business interruption is being transmitted through transport corridors and public systems. Typhoon-related disruption in eastern Japan, a landslide on the Hatton Bogawantalawa Route and flooding that left part of Highway 401 impassable for small vehicles all slow staff movement and time-sensitive distribution where alternative routing is limited.

The more contingent exposures are administrative and energy frictions. The LTFRB platform outage after a data breach can delay transactions that depend on the system, while Nepal's LPG shortage can constrain fuel-dependent operations if planned imports fail to ease availability.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

PAKISTAN | KOHAT KOHAT POLICE HEADQUARTERS ATTACKED

Security · Extreme · 18 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: An explosion and gun attack hit a police headquarters in Kohat, and the death toll rose to at least 31 including 16 police personnel. Fighting was still ongoing when the toll was reported.

POLESTAR VIEW: Known: a severe local security incident is active. Unproven: wider commercial transport disruption beyond the immediate area.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for official confirmation that fighting has ended and whether access controls around Kohat are tightened or lifted.

SOURCES: Ratopati; Sahara Reporters; ; thepamphlet.in; Pragativadi; The Hindu; kashmirilife.net; Kashmir Life; malaysiasun.com; Bangkok Post; Revoi.in; Onlinekhabar English; Business Recorder

JAPAN | EASTERN JAPAN TYPHOON DUJUAN DISRUPTS EASTERN TRANSPORT

Weather & Natural Hazards · Moderate · 21 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Typhoon Dujuan was approaching eastern Japan with heavy rain and transport disruption.

POLESTAR VIEW: Known: transport reliability is already degraded. Conditional: business interruption depends on which services or corridors are actually curtailed.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for reports identifying affected lines, roads or airports as the typhoon approaches eastern Japan.

SOURCES: SuaraGarut.ID

NEPAL NEPAL LPG SHORTAGE PERSISTS

Energy · Moderate · 20 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Nepal is facing a severe LPG shortage linked to import failures. Nepal plans to import 160 gas bullets daily to ease the shortage.

POLESTAR VIEW: Known: shortage persists and extra imports are planned. Conditional: operational stress eases only if daily gas-bullet imports improve distribution.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch whether the planned 160 daily gas-bullet imports begin and are reported to ease shortages.

SOURCES: Ratopati; Nepalnews.com

PHILIPPINES LTFRB PLATFORM GOES OFFLINE

Cyber · Moderate · 19 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: LTFRB is probing a data breach after its platform went offline.

POLESTAR VIEW: Known: platform downtime followed a reported breach probe. Unknown: scale of data exposure and whether processing delays become material.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for official updates on platform restoration or confirmation that submissions are being handled through alternatives.

SOURCES: Inquirer.net

**SRI LANKA | HATTON BOGAWANTALAWA ROUTE
LANDSLIDE CUTS HATTON BOGAWANTALAWA ROUTE****Weather & Natural Hazards · Moderate · 21 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: A landslide cut off the Hatton Bogawantalawa Route and disrupted Hill Country journeys.

POLESTAR VIEW: Known: a specific route disruption is affecting Hill Country journeys. Conditional: broader commercial impact depends on closure duration and available alternates.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for clearance updates or confirmation that traffic is being diverted onto workable alternate routes.

SOURCES: *nomadlawyer.org*

**THAILAND
FLOODING BLOCKS HIGHWAY 401****Weather & Natural Hazards · Moderate · 19 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: Heavy rain caused flooding along Highway 401 in Surat Thani, leaving the road impassable for small vehicles. Authorities evacuated Thai and foreign tourists from the affected area.

POLESTAR VIEW: Known: flooding has made part of the route impassable for small vehicles. Unclear: whether larger vehicles or alternate corridors can absorb traffic.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for water-level changes and official notice that Highway 401 has reopened to small vehicles.

SOURCES: *Khaosod English*

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

Security and weather disruptions both require near-term movement decisions. In and around Kohat, employers should defer non-essential staff movement or meetings if operations touch the affected area while fighting remains ongoing. In eastern Japan and on disrupted routes in Sri Lanka and southern Thailand, transport teams should switch to route-by-route confirmation before dispatch or staff travel where heavy rain, landslide damage or flooding has already interrupted journeys.

Road and fuel constraints warrant targeted continuity choices. Logistics managers with exposure to Highway 401 or the Hatton Bogawantalawa corridor should reroute loads that cannot tolerate local delays, triggered by confirmed impassability for small vehicles and route cut-off. In Nepal, fuel-dependent operators should review local LPG coverage and prioritise critical consumption only if the planned daily imports do not materially improve availability.

The LTFRB platform outage creates a systems dependency issue rather than a proven transport stoppage. Firms needing regulator-facing submissions or platform-based transactions should identify any backlog-sensitive tasks and hold manual workarounds ready, triggered by continued offline status or confirmation that breach remediation is delaying access beyond routine interruption.

7 DAY WATCH

ISLAMABAD, PAKISTAN — PTI nationwide protest and long march to Islamabad

Watch: Track route and venue advisories, transport changes and police restrictions.

JAKARTA, INDONESIA — National Farmers Day, Semanggi II and Black September demonstrations

Watch: Track venue advisories, organiser confirmation and any police restrictions.

JAKARTA, INDONESIA — Conditional KPSI Employment Bill labour demonstration

Watch: Track venue advisories, organiser confirmation and any police restrictions.

INDIA — Bank Strike September 28-30: SBI Issues Advisory, Check Services That Will Remain Available

Watch: Track organiser confirmation, transport changes and cancellation or postponement notices.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

The top unresolved risk is whether the Kohat attack remains a tightly localised security incident or continues to impede nearby business activity. The key decision signals are whether fighting is declared over and whether any new official access restrictions around the area are reported.

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